

Postmortem: payments timeouts after the v2.31 deploy

Incident date	2026-10-02, night (JST)
Severity	SEV-2
Incident commander	Aiko
Author	Mei
Status	Final, reviewed 2026-10-05

Summary

At 02:14 JST we deployed payments v2.31. The release cut the database connection pool for payments from 50 to 20. Even at night traffic, checkout requests began to wait for a free connection, and the payments p95 latency went above 2 seconds at 02:28. Client retries added load and made the wait longer. We rolled back to v2.30 starting at 02:58, and payments were restored at 03:07.

Impact

- Customer impact window: 02:18 to 03:07 JST (49 minutes).
- Failed payments: 1,184. All were replayed from the retry queue by 03:12. No customer was charged twice.
- Delayed payments (completed, but slower than 2 seconds): 3,907.
- Support tickets: 23.
- The api p95 latency rose to about 530 ms, because checkout calls in api wait on payments.

Root cause

The pool size lives in a config file. The change was reviewed as "no functional change" and was not load tested. With 20 connections, each slow database call held a connection longer, the queue grew, and retries from the app added more requests to the same queue.

Action items

1. Alert on payments connection wait time, not only on p95 latency (owner: Ravi, due 2026-10-16).
2. Any change to pool sizes needs a load test before deploy (owner: Mei, due 2026-10-16).
3. Client retries for checkout use backoff with jitter (owner: Aiko, due 2026-10-23).

Timeline (JST)

Time	What happened	Who
02:14	Payments v2.31 deployed. The release cuts the database connection pool from 50 to 20.	Mei
02:21	First support ticket: the checkout spinner does not finish.	Hana (Support)
02:30	Alert fires: payments p95 above 2 s for 2 minutes. Page sent to on-call.	PagerDuty
02:34	Page acknowledged.	Ravi
02:39	Payments logs show requests waiting for a database connection.	Ravi
02:43	Incident declared (SEV-2). Aiko takes incident commander.	Aiko
02:47	Mei joins and points at the pool size change in v2.31.	Mei
02:50	Payments p95 peaks at 3.7 s. Client retries push the request rate up by about 80%.	Ravi
02:56	Decision to roll back payments to v2.30.	Aiko
02:58	Rollback to v2.30 started.	Mei
03:04	Rollback complete on all payments pods.	Mei
03:07	Payments p95 back under 500 ms. Payments restored.	Ravi
03:12	1,184 failed payments replayed from the retry queue.	Mei
03:20	Receipt emails for the replayed payments sent.	Tom